

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 560

By Barrett

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Virginia Gray of Dickson County.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Virginia Gray; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Gray was a beloved member of her community who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, the daughter of Warren and Edith Rosenbalm, Virginia Gray was born on March 6, 1940, and raised alongside her older brother, Donald, in humble beginnings but with big dreams; and

WHEREAS, she met the love of her life, Earl Gray, while in college; the young couple married in 1963 and built a beautiful life together on Gray's Hilltop Farm in Dickson County, their partnership marked by laughter, hard work, shared values, and an abiding love for one another; and

WHEREAS, a proud graduate of Dickson High School, where she was voted "Most Intellectual," and of Austin Peay State University, where she earned two degrees, Virginia Gray dedicated her life to learning and sharing knowledge as a gifted educator, serving more than three decades in Dickson County Schools as a teacher, supervisor, and principal; and

WHEREAS, even after taking a well-deserved retirement, Mrs. Gray remained committed to teaching, as she tutored Japanese families and remained deeply engaged in her community; and

WHEREAS, Virginia Gray was a civic-minded leader, giving generously of her time and talents as a Dickson County commissioner, Rotary Club president, chair of the Dickson County Retired Teachers Association scholarship committee, member of the Library Board, and member of the Renaissance Choir; and

WHEREAS, her legendary gatherings—from her famous Thanksgiving feasts that welcomed fifty or more guests to the unforgettable Gray Boys Old Time Wheat Threshing

events—brought people together with warmth, music, food, and storytelling, creating lasting memories and deep connections; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Gray was renowned for her homemade biscuits, fried chicken, sharp wit, artistic talents, and the ability to find and share joy in the everyday, especially through stories of life on the farm; and

WHEREAS, left to cherish her memory are adoring husband, Earl; daughter, Ginny; son-in-law, Craig; and grandson, Gray; she also cherished her extended family of brothers- and sisters-in-law, nieces, nephews, and many friends; and

WHEREAS, Virginia Gray leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Virginia Gray, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mrs. Gray.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.